

L008: Patient Admission & Triage Questions

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Lane B — Medical English

Section 1 — Key Vocabulary

1. admission

/əd'mɪʃən/ noun

The formal process of accepting a patient into hospital care.

"The admission process includes completing a consent form and medical history."

Tagalog: pagpasok ng pasyente sa ospital

2. presenting complaint

/prɪ'zentɪŋ kəm'pleɪnt/ noun phrase

The main symptom or reason a patient has come to the hospital.

"The patient's presenting complaint is severe abdominal pain for 12 hours."

Tagalog: pangunahing dahilan ng pagpunta sa ospital

3. medical history

/'medɪkəl 'hɪstəri/ noun phrase

A record of a patient's past illnesses, surgeries, and medications.

"Do you have any significant medical history I should be aware of?"

Tagalog: kasaysayan ng kalusugan ng pasyente

4. allergy

/'ælərdʒi/ noun

An adverse reaction to a substance such as a medication or food.

"Are you allergic to any medications, particularly penicillin?"

Tagalog: alerhiya

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5. consent

/kən'sent/ noun/verb

Permission given by a patient for a medical procedure or treatment.

"I need your consent before we proceed with the examination."

Tagalog: pahintulot ng pasyente

6. next of kin

/nekst əv kɪn/ noun phrase

The patient's closest living relative or emergency contact.

"Could you provide the name and number of your next of kin?"

Tagalog: pinakamalapit na kamag-anak

7. current medications

/'kɜːrənt ,medɪ'keɪʃənz/ noun phrase

All medicines the patient is presently taking.

"Please list all your current medications, including supplements."

Tagalog: kasalukuyang gamot

8. triage category

/'triːɑːʒ 'kætɪgəri/ noun phrase

A classification of urgency assigned to a patient on arrival.

"Based on your vital signs, I'm assigning you a triage category of two — urgent."

Tagalog: kategorya ng pag-uuri ng pasyente

Section 2 — Phrases & Patterns

What brings you in today?

Open-ended admission opener.

"Good morning, Mr. Dela Cruz. What brings you in today?"

Can you describe the pain for me?

Elicit symptom detail.

"Can you describe the pain for me — is it sharp, dull, or burning?"

Are you currently taking any medications?

Medication check.

"Are you currently taking any medications, including over-the-counter drugs?"

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I need to take your details for our records.

Frame the admission process.

"Before the doctor sees you, I need to take your details for our records."

Do you have any known allergies?

Safety-critical question.

"Do you have any known allergies to medications or anaesthesia?"

Section 3 — Scenario Practice

Read the dialogue aloud. Circle any words you found difficult to pronounce.

Admissions Nurse: Good morning. My name is Nurse Reyes. What brings you in today?

Patient: I've had severe stomach pain since last night. It's getting worse.

Admissions Nurse: I'm sorry to hear that. Can you describe the pain for me — is it sharp, dull, or cramping?

Patient: It's sharp, mostly on the right side.

Admissions Nurse: On a scale of one to ten, how would you rate it right now?

Patient: About an eight.

Admissions Nurse: Understood. Do you have any known allergies to medications?

Patient: Yes, I'm allergic to penicillin.

Admissions Nurse: Thank you — I've noted that. Are you currently taking any medications?

Patient: Just metformin for diabetes.

Admissions Nurse: Perfect. I need to take your next of kin details as well. Based on your symptoms, I'm assigning you a triage category of two — urgent. The doctor will see you very shortly.

Section 4 — Self-Evaluation

After completing the exercises, tick each item you feel confident about:

I can complete a patient admission using all the key phrases from this lesson.

I can ask about presenting complaint, allergies, and current medications confidently.

I can explain a triage category to a patient in plain English.

I can use 'consent', 'next of kin', and 'medical history' correctly in sentences.

Section 5 — My Notes

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